



United States[™]
Census
Bureau

Request for Collaboration (RFC)

**2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census
Decennial as a Service (D-X)
April 14, 2026**

Purpose of This Follow-up Request for Collaboration

The U.S. Census Bureau (USCB) is issuing this **Request for Collaboration (RFC)** to follow on the insights gained from the initial [Decennial-as-a-Service \(D-X\) Request for Information \(RFI\)](#) SAM notice #13PDRD25Q00000007 on 8/14/25, to gather additional industry input on areas not fully addressed in the original RFI responses. As we continue refining our acquisition strategy, the USCB remains committed to transparency, open communication, and meaningful collaboration with industry partners. Accordingly, this RFC is designed to:

- Address capability areas not fully addressed in the original RFI
- Validate assumptions and operational models held by the government
- Encourage industry to share best practices, risks, and integration strategies
- Strengthen alignment between government expectations and commercial capabilities
- Support a more informed, evidence-based acquisition approach

The detailed scope and operational descriptions provided in the initial [D-X RFI](#) continue to serve as the baseline for this RFC. Please consider that information when assessing capability gaps or dependencies.

The Census Bureau values industry expertise and seeks to ensure that the D-X solution is shaped through open dialogue, shared understanding, and collaborative problem-solving.

This RFC seeks industry partners capable of delivering a single fully integrated, nationwide equipment and endpoint lifecycle management ecosystem, operating under a single-integrator model, to support logistics, equipment handling, cellular services, site deployments, and operational support functions necessary for the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Decennial Census operational readiness across all states and U.S. territories.

BACKGROUND

The objective of the D-X program is to deliver a complete, as-a-service solution for centralized management of standard equipment and mobile devices that ensures cybersecurity compliance, operational efficiency, cost transparency, and end-to-end lifecycle accountability, while meeting all schedule milestones for the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Decennial Census, including site deployment and teardown timelines, mobile device deployment cycles, ATO approvals, and system go-live dates. The D-X solution must be a turnkey, FedRAMP-authorized, NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5-compliant, ATO-authorized, as-a-service operational ecosystem, coordinated under a single-integrator model, and including but not limited to the following capabilities:

- Devices, equipment and asset management services
 - End-to-end management of all standard equipment and devices provided as-a-service, including but not limited to mobile devices, peripherals, networking gear, printers/MFPs, and paper data capture equipment
 - Mobile device provisioning, configuration, and deployment
 - Equipment maintenance, repair, replacement and compliant disposition
 - Inventory accuracy, chain-of-custody tracking, and real-time asset visibility
- Logistics, Warehousing, and Deployment Operations
 - Warehousing (secure and nonsecure), kitting, staging, and order fulfillment for mobile devices and other equipment, with support for flexible delivery options such as informed delivery to individual residences, delivery rerouting, and a range of alternative delivery methods proposed by industry to meet large-scale, distributed Census operational needs.
 - Shipping, returns, and reverse-logistics workflows that incorporate flexible delivery and return capabilities, including informed delivery notifications, delivery rerouting, scheduled pickup windows, carrier-agnostic drop-off options, and other alternative delivery/return methods appropriate for nationwide and U.S. territory based field operations, supporting deliveries to and from field offices, regional census offices, satellite operational sites, and individual employees' residences across all states and U.S. territories.
 - Support for site deployments across all states and U.S. territories, including remote and island locations, including installation of vendor supplied equipment, peripherals, and other site-based infrastructure required to establish fully operational field offices.
- Mobility, Unified Endpoint Management (UEM), and Cellular Services
 - UEM for device configuration, compliance, patching, and security baselines, and cross-platform governance to ensure that all mobile devices, regardless of operating system or management platform, follow the same security baselines, configuration standards, compliance requirements, and lifecycle controls.
 - Mobile Device Management (MDM) for device enrollment, policy enforcement, compliance monitoring, and lifecycle controls
 - Coordination of mobile device provisioning throughout deployment cycles, including device setup, and readiness checks to ensure assets are fully operational.
 - Cellular service activation, eSIM management, coverage optimization, and surge capacity
 - Integration of mobility, identity, and security baselines across all devices

- Security, Compliance, and Continuous Monitoring
 - FedRAMP-authorized, NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5-compliant hosting and security controls, with continuous monitoring and reporting aligned to federal requirements
 - Continuous monitoring, vulnerability management, and incident response coordination
 - Integration of mobility, identity, and endpoint security baselines across all devices and platforms
 - Incident detection, escalation, and Tier 3 security response coordinated with Census security operations
 - Secure data handling, media sanitization, and compliant disposition processes
- Operational Support, Maintenance, and ITSM Integration
 - Tier 3 technical support and engineering-level issue resolution integrated with the Government's ITSM platform
 - Incident, request, and change management workflows aligned to Census processes and cross-vendor escalation paths
 - Performance monitoring, SLA tracking, and escalation governance across all XaaS service areas
- Reporting, Analytics, and Automation
 - Real-time dashboards for inventory, logistics, deployments, cellular usage, and support performance
 - Predictive analytics for demand planning, device health, and operational readiness
 - Automation to streamline provisioning, updates, and service workflows
- Program, Vendor, and Contract Management
 - Centralized coordination under a single-integrator model
 - Governance model that oversees and coordinates all Everything-as-a-Service providers and government systems
 - Risk management, performance oversight, and continuous improvement

Transparency and Collaboration

- This notice is part of our broader effort to build a collaborative, transparent, and industry-informed acquisition environment for D-X. The Census Bureau may work to support a fair, informed, and well-aligned acquisition process through the following: Publishing relevant operational plans, schedules, milestones, and mission constraints, as available, to help industry tailor responses to the realities of Census field operations on

the [2030 Decennial Census Website](https://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/decennial-census/decade/2030/2030-census-main.html) (<https://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/decennial-census/decade/2030/2030-census-main.html>).

- Engaging in two-way, iterative communication, including follow-up questions, reverse vendor days, and other collaborative forums, to explore ideas, clarify concepts, and refine approaches with industry when possible.
- Inviting industry feedback on feasibility, risks, and alternatives, and ensuring vendors have equal access to the information needed to develop well-informed responses.

Additional Information for Industry

The following areas were not fully addressed in the original RFI and require input to support planning, integration, and acquisition strategy development.

For the purposes of this RFC, “Everything-as-a-Service (XaaS)” refers to a fully managed, subscription-based service model in which vendors deliver the tools, technology, processes, people, and outcomes required to support Census operations. This includes OEM-agnostic solutions, integrated service delivery, predictable pricing, and end-to-end lifecycle management across multiple service domains. The Census Bureau uses XaaS to describe a unified ecosystem of managed services that collectively supports the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census.

Managed Service Integrator (MSI) Model

The USCB is considering a single-integrator model in which one Managed Service Integrator (MSI) provides end-to-end orchestration across all D-X service domains. This MSI would coordinate multiple XaaS providers and ensure unified governance, interoperability, and accountability across logistics, mobility, devices, warehousing, asset management, cellular services, site deployments, and support operations. The USCB is seeking industry insight into MSI models, governance structures, and best practices for managing a large, multi-vendor ecosystem under a single-integrator construct.

Assumptions:

- Demonstrated experience coordinating many different operational areas, such as logistics, devices, mobility, cellular services, site deployments, and support, so they function as one integrated service.
- Proven tools and processes to keep all systems and vendors aligned, sharing accurate data, and working together smoothly across the entire operation.
- Can manage and support Decennial Census operations across all states and U.S. territories, including remote and island locations, making sure equipment, deployments, logistics, cellular services, and support all work together smoothly at nationwide scale.
- Takes responsibility for delivering consistent, end-to-end service outcomes across all operational areas, not just managing individual vendors

Command Center Assumptions

The D-X vision includes a Command Center that provides a real-time operational layer that provides continuous visibility, coordinated response, and cross-domain decision support across the D-X ecosystem. It unifies data from logistics, asset management, endpoint management, cellular services, and help desk workflows into a single operational view, enabling leadership and operations teams to monitor service health, track incidents and requests across departments, and take action without switching between systems.

Assumptions:

- Provides a unified operational picture that enables real-time monitoring of service health, incident trends, and cross-domain workflow status across all D-X service areas.
- Enables proactive operations, including endpoint health monitoring, vulnerability tracking, and field service coordination, by leveraging integrated data and automated alerting across all tiers.
- Supports coordinated incident response and case routing across IT, HR, Safety, Logistics, and field operations, ensuring that leadership and operational teams can track progress and take action from a single environment.
- Operates on a common data foundation that may support AI-driven automation, allowing the system to autonomously resolve requests, execute multi-step workflows, and complete end-to-end actions within established policies.

Data Interoperability and Integration

D-X will rely on a combination of multiple commercial and government systems working together seamlessly. To achieve this, the USCB must understand how vendors approach data integration, API frameworks, synchronization, and real-time visibility across disparate platforms, including those operated by federal partners. We are seeking industry insight into best practices, integration patterns, and potential challenges associated with building a unified operational ecosystem that spans both commercial and government environments.

Assumptions:

- Integrates commercial and government systems into a unified operational ecosystem that supports seamless data exchange and coordinated service delivery.
- Applies federal and commercial best practices to ensure data quality, synchronization, and real-time visibility across diverse platforms and partner environments.
- Provides end-to-end integration across logistics, UEM, cellular, and asset management systems to enable consistent, mission-ready operations.

OEM-Agnostic Device and Equipment As-a-Service Models

The USCB is evaluating OEM-agnostic as-a-service models for mobile devices (smartphones, tablets, laptops), office equipment (printers, multifunction devices), paper data-capture equipment (scanners, letter openers, guillotines), and office networking equipment (access points, servers, and related infrastructure). These models may include brand-specific or equivalent configurations where required. The USCB seeks industry input on how such as-a-service offerings are typically structured commercially, including provisioning approaches, service levels, lifecycle services, refresh strategies, and performance management. The USCB also requests information on risks, dependencies, and constraints that should be considered when implementing an enterprise-scale, multi-vendor as-a-service model.

Assumptions:

- Bundles diverse equipment categories, including mobile devices, office and paper data capture equipment, scanners, and networking hardware, into a unified, scalable, OEM-agnostic program that delivers provisioning, kitting, and lifecycle services.
- Predictable pricing, refresh cycles, and service-level commitments that are in alignment with other large-scale as-a-service programs, including break/fix services, rapid replacement SLAs, inventory pooling, buffer stock strategies, and secure end-of-life disposition.
- Supports enterprise-scale device volumes, including approximately 360,000 smartphones, 20,000 tablets, and 20,000 laptops, with the ability to surge or de-surge inventory and services based on operational tempo and field deployment needs.
- Provide cellular service for all mobile devices nationwide across all states and U.S. territories by leveraging the best-performing local carriers in each area, supported by performance monitoring, availability metrics, and rapid carrier remediation pathways.
- Support carrier flexibility through eSIM or equivalent technologies, supporting local area code assignments where possible and allowing devices to switch carriers or profiles dynamically to maintain coverage, performance, and operational continuity.
- Support OEM-agnostic service delivery of mission-specific requirements for brand-specific or equivalent equipment (e.g., printers, scanners, access points, servers), while ensuring consistent provisioning, configuration, support, and lifecycle management across all equipment types.
- Integrate with the USCB's enterprise platforms to support incident management, asset tracking, request fulfillment, and performance reporting, enabling unified visibility across all vendors and equipment categories.

Warehouse Operations Capabilities as a Service

Warehouse operations are central to D-X, supporting receiving, storage, picking, packing, kitting, and shipping for hundreds of thousands of assets. The USCB is exploring warehouse operations as a managed service to improve throughput, accuracy, and scalability. We are seeking industry insight into operational models, automation technologies, and quality-control practices that support high-volume federal deployments.

Assumptions:

- Provides warehouse operations as a managed service, including secure and nonsecure storage, receiving Government-Furnished Material (GFM), consumables, kitting, staging, order fulfillment, and support for flexible delivery and return options such as informed delivery, rerouting, secure locker pickup, carrier-agnostic drop-off, scheduled pickups, and prepaid/QR-code return labels.
 - ~ 300,000 square feet of secure warehouse space may be required to support the storage, kitting, staging, and distribution of mobile devices, equipment, and related materials.
 - Additional nonsecure space will be needed for Government Furnished Materials (GFM), the volume of which is not yet known
- Utilizes diverse nationwide shipping methods, returns, and reverse-logistics workflows that maintain chain-of-custody, provide real-time asset visibility, and support high-volume throughput using automation, robotics, and optimization technologies across all operations.
- Supports delivery of mobile devices, accessories, and vendor-provided equipment to field offices, regional census offices, temporary operational sites, and individual employees' residences.
- Delivers coordinated site deployment and readiness services, including provisioning, aiding equipment installation, and full field office readiness validation throughout deployment cycles.

Surge Readiness and Scalability

The Decennial Census requires rapid, high-volume scaling during peak operational periods. As previously shared, during the 2020 Census, vendors staged, provisioned, and kitted 50,000–70,000 mobile devices at peak and shipped more than 100,000 devices per week in advance of in-field data collection. To achieve full geographic office coverage, site deployment teams established approximately 25–30 new operational sites per week across multiple waves. As we prepare for D-X, the USCB must understand how vendors plan for surge staffing, facility expansion, supply chain acceleration, device provisioning, and large-scale logistics under similar

or greater time-compressed conditions. We are seeking industry input on surge models, lead times, and proven strategies for supporting mobilizations of this magnitude.

Assumptions:

- Design and execute surge models capable of supporting peak volumes similar to the 2020 Decennial Census requirements (e.g., 50,000–70,000 devices staged at peak, 100,000+ weekly shipments, and 25–30 new site deployments per week).
- Deliver commercial strategies, staffing models, and facility expansions to enable rapid scale-up and scale-down during time-compressed mobilizations, and what lead times are typically required to achieve these peak census volumes.
- Deliver and manage multiple provisioning models, including Zero Touch Mobility, and other large-scale approaches, that support distributed Census operations while maintaining quality, accuracy, and configuration consistency during high-volume surges.

Sustainability and Reuse Models

Sustainability is a priority for the USCB. D-X will require environmentally responsible approaches to device reuse, kit reuse, and recycling. We are seeking industry insight into sustainable practices, certifications, and reuse models that can be applied at national scale.

Assumptions:

- Prioritize the reuse of mobile devices, accessories, kits, and Government-Furnished Material (GFM) consumables, supported by environmentally responsible lifecycle and disposition practices.
- Prioritize sustainability practices or certifications consistent with large-scale federal operations.

Risk Identification and Mitigation

Given the scale and complexity of D-X, the USCB is proactively identifying risks that could impact service delivery, integration, or operational readiness. We are seeking candid industry insight into potential risks, dependencies, and mitigation strategies based on commercial experience with large, multi-domain service environments.

Encouraging Open Dialogue

The goal of the Census Bureau, regarding the D-X program, is to facilitate candid, constructive discussions with constructive feedback. It is through these ongoing engagements we plan to work with industry on the following:

- Identify gaps or assumptions in the government’s current approach
- Consider alternative models or architecture
- Identify and integrate leading industry best practices

- Suggest areas where additional government transparency would improve solution design
- Provide opportunities for information exchanges, or collaborative workshops as deemed necessary

Our goal is to ensure that the D-X acquisition is informed by real-world expertise, proven commercial practices, and shared understanding.

DISCLAIMER AND IMPORTANT NOTES

This RFC issued solely for planning purposes only and does not constitute as a Request for Proposal (RFP) or a promise to issue a Request for Proposal (RFP) in the future. Further, the USCB is not seeking proposals and will not accept unsolicited proposals at this time. Interested parties are advised that the U.S. Government will not pay for any information or administrative costs incurred in response to this RFC; all costs associated with responding to this RFC will be solely at the interested party's expense. Not responding to this RFC does not preclude participation in any future RFP, if any is issued. Lastly, this RFC does not commit the Government to contract for any supply or service whatsoever. The Government is not obligated to respond to any submissions received under this RFC.

Any organization responding to this notice should ensure that its response is complete and sufficiently detailed to allow the Government to determine the organization's qualifications to perform the work. Respondents are advised that the Government is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted. The Government may contact individual respondents for additional follow-up or to request additional information. After a review of the responses received, a pre-solicitation synopsis and solicitation may be published.

After a review of responses, the Government may at its discretion contact any respondent to obtain clarification on information provided.

RESPONSE SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

Interested vendors shall submit a response no later than **Thursday, May 14, 2026**, at 4:00 PM EST. All submissions shall be sent to pithy.t.sar@census.gov and paul.w.boesch@census.gov. The email subject line shall include the following description: **“Census D-X RFC Response- *COMPANY NAME*”**.

The overall submission shall be prepared in Microsoft Word, using Times New Roman, 12-point font. The submission shall follow the section page limitations identified below.

Section	Title	Maximum Page Count
A	Company Overview Information	1
B	Integrated Service Delivery and Operational Coordination	6
C	Acquisition Approach and Evaluation Considerations	2
D	Closing Thoughts and Feedback	3

The USCB is seeking practical responses over conceptual or marketing-driven answers.

Company Overview Information:

All interested companies shall provide the following information:

- Business name, company website, and headquarters address.
- Name of company representative, business title, and contact information.
- Unique Entity ID.
- Socio-economic status, business size, and size standard/applicable.
- Applicable and available North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) codes related to this acquisition.
- Applicable and available GSA contracting vehicle and include contract numbers, agency, POC, and KO. Examples include GWACs, GSA Federal Supply Schedules, MAS, Other Transaction Agreement (OTA), Direct Award, or other Best in Class (BIC) vehicles related to this acquisition.
- Brief description of your relevant core corporate abilities that relate to the requirements stated in RFC.

Integrated Service Delivery and Operational Coordination:

1. Given the nationwide scale of D-X and the need to manage logistics, warehousing, mobile devices, site deployments, cybersecurity, support services, and overall operational performance as one coordinated service across all states and U.S. territories, describe your organization’s ability to deliver this full scope as a unified, as-a-service solution. Identify how you would ensure everything works together smoothly.

2. Describe your experience delivering nationwide as-a-service solutions that combined any of the following: logistics, device management, site deployments, cybersecurity, and support operations into one coordinated service across all states and U.S. territories. Include examples where these services were delivered under a unified performance and accountability model. Additionally, describe how you coordinated across service areas to meet strict operational schedules and milestones.
3. Describe your experience supporting delivery and return workflows that serve a distributed operationally driven organization, including field offices, regional offices, temporary operational sites, and individual employees' residences across all states and U.S. territories. Include examples of how you managed flexible delivery options, chain-of-custody, identity verification, and return logistics at this scale.
4. Explain how your organization integrates multiple service areas, such as logistics, device provisioning, site readiness, security, and support services, into a single ecosystem with shared data, coordinated workflows, and unified reporting. Describe the tools, processes, and governance structures you use to maintain consistency, quality, and accountability across all service areas and partners.

Acquisition Approach and Evaluation Considerations:

1. If the USCB were to move forward with a solicitation for these services, identify evaluation factors that may be most effective in determining capability in meeting the full scope and objectives described through this RFC? Provide specific capabilities, performance areas, or qualifications that may be emphasized in the evaluation and describe why.
2. The USCB intends to streamline and innovate this requirement and resultant solicitation, evaluation, and award. Please review the Periodic Table of Acquisition Innovations at <https://acquisitiongateway.gov/periodic-table> and identify innovative techniques that may provide value to the USCB and describe why.
3. The USCB is seeking industry feedback to refine the requirements and identify the appropriate acquisition approach. Specifically, the USCB welcomes input on the type of requirement approach that makes the most sense for this effort (e.g., Statement of Objectives (SOO), Performance Work Statement (PWS), etc.), as well as recommendations related to contract type structure, performance metrics, and industry best practices related to this effort. This feedback will assist the USCB in shaping the most appropriate procurement framework and in developing complete and effective requirements for any future solicitation. Provide an acquisition approach and describe why.

Closing Thoughts and Feedback:

1. Were there any objectives, assumptions, or service descriptions in this RFC that may benefit from additional clarification or refinement. What specific information would help industry better understand the USCB's intent and provide more informed input?
2. Is there additional information about your organization's experience, capabilities, or operational strengths, particularly in delivering large, integrated, nationwide service models, that would help the USCB better understand your ability to support the objectives described in this RFC?
3. Is there anything important to this effort that the USCB has not asked about but should consider? Please limit your response to information specific to this RFC.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Information submitted must be available at no cost or obligation to the Government.

Submissions become Government property and will not be returned, including any proprietary information; any information you consider proprietary should be clearly marked as such.

The Government may consider additional communication as part of the ongoing market research and may reach out at a later date requesting more information. Service providers who do not respond to this Market Research form are not excluded from any resulting solicitation(s).